Minutes of the
General Government Committee Meeting
Held in the River Plate Room, Ajax Town Hall
At 1:00 p.m. on December 20, 2019

Alternative formats available upon request by contacting:
accessibility@ajax.ca or 905-619-2529 ext. 3347

Present:	Chair - Councillor	A. Khan
	Regional Councillors	M. Crawford
		S. Lee
		J. Dies
	Councillors	R. Tyler Morin (exited at 3:29 p.m.)
		L. Bower
	Mayor	S. Collier

1. Call to Order

Chair Khan called the meeting to order at 1:00 p.m.

Chair Khan noted one additional item to be added to the open agenda, and one additional item to be added to the closed session agenda.

Motion to Suspend the Rules of Procedure

Moved by: S. Lee

That the rules of procedure be suspended to permit the addition of two items to the agenda without notice:

1. 'Expression of Interest in United Shoreline Ontario Rally' (open agenda, item 4.10); and

2. 'Durham Live Minor Variance Applications' (closed agenda, item 7.2) – pursuant to section 239 (2)(e) of the *Municipal Act*, a matter pertaining to litigation or potential litigation, including matters before administrative tribunals, affecting the municipality or local board.

CARRIED (2/3rds)

2. Disclosure of Pecuniary Interest

There were no disclosures of pecuniary interests.

3. Adoption of Minutes

3.1 Regular Meeting

Moved by: L. Bower

That the Minutes of the regular meeting of the General Government Committee held on November 11, 2019 be adopted.

CARRIED

3.2 Closed Session

Moved by: S. Collier

That the Minutes of the Closed Session of the General Government Committee held on November 11, 2019 be adopted.

CARRIED

3.3 2020 Capital Budget & 2021-2024 Long Range Capital Forecast – December 2, 2019

A correction was noted to page 3 of the minutes of the December 2, 2019 meeting regarding the Town's 70th anniversary.

Moved by: M. Crawford

That the Minutes of the 2020 Capital Budget & 2021-2024 Long Range Capital Forecast held on December 2, 2019 be adopted.

CARRIED

4. Consent Agenda

Members separated items 4.1, 4.2, 4.3, 4.4, 4.6, and 4.9 for discussion.

Moved by: M. Crawford

That items 4.5, 4.7, and 4.8 of the consent agenda be adopted.

CARRIED

4.1 Council Communications Tools & Support Policy

Committee Members discussed the options presented in the report and asked questions regarding associated costs in staff time, and motions on Council members' profiles on the ajax.ca website. Rachael Wraith, Acting Manager of Public & Strategic Affairs, and Devon Jarvis, Administrative Assistant – Council, responded to questions from Committee Members and discussed staff time commitments and use of Council members' website profiles. Committee Members considered requesting staff to report back to review the effectiveness of a printed newsletter.

Main Motion

That Council approve a Ward Constituent Newsletter option for the Council Communications Tools & Support Policy, and

That the Council Communications Tools & Support Policy - #143 be approved.

Amendment

Moved by: S. Lee

That the motion be amended to read as follows:

1. That Council adopt Ward Newsletter Option 'A' as outlined in the report for a period of two years;

2. That staff be directed to report back at the end of the two-year period with a review of feedback received and the effectiveness of the Ward Newsletter; and

3. That the Council Communications Tools & Support Policy - #143 be approved, as amended.

CARRIED

Main Motion as Amended

Moved by: S. Lee

1. That Council adopt Ward Newsletter Option 'A' as outlined in the report for a period of two years;

2. That staff be directed to report back at the end of the two-year period with a review of feedback received and the effectiveness of the Ward Newsletter; and

3. That the Council Communications Tools & Support Policy - #143 be approved, as amended.

CARRIED

4.2 Naming Rights Policy

Committee Members asked questions regarding annual revenue potential, uses for the funds received, and seeking community feedback on specific facilities for naming rights. Kassandra Cruciano, Grants and Strategic Initiatives Coordinator, responded to questions from Committee Members and discussed revenue potential, uses for the funds received, and the evaluation process for potential naming rights agreements.

Moved by: S. Collier

That the new Naming Rights Policy be approved by Council;

That staff be directed by Council to develop and maintain a registry of appropriate properties for potential naming rights opportunities;

That staff implement a strategy to solicit naming rights opportunities beginning in 2020;

That the Office of the CAO be directed to provide annual updates to Council on naming rights; and

That staff be authorized by Council to make minor amendments to related corporate policies to ensure consistency with the new policy.

CARRIED

4.3 2019 Operating Budget Forecast

Committee Members asked questions regarding the budget timetable and use of surplus funds. Sandra Serrao, Acting Director of Finance/Treasurer, responded to questions from Committee Members and discussed the annual capital and operating budget timetable and permitted uses of surplus funds.

Moved by: S. Lee

That the report on the 2019 Operating Budget Forecast be received as information.

CARRIED

4.4 Library Reserve and Policy

Committee Members asked questions regarding use of the Ajax Public Library reserve and allocation of surplus funds. S. Serrao and Donna Bright, Chief Librarian, responded to questions from Committee Members and reviewed the reserve fund and use of library's surplus.

Moved by: S. Lee

That this report be received for information.

CARRIED

4.5 Emergency Management Annual Report & By-law Update

Moved by: M. Crawford

1. That the Town of Ajax Emergency Management Program Committee Annual Report be received for information.

2. That the recommended changes to the Town of Ajax Emergency Response Plan and associated By-law be approved by Council.

CARRIED

4.6 Public Conduct Policy

Committee Members asked questions regarding applicability of the proposed policy to the conduct of the public towards Council Members, and inappropriate comments or behaviour on official and unofficial social media channels. Alexander Harras, Manager of Legislative Services / Deputy Clerk, and Nicole Coper, Director of Legislative & Information Services / Town Clerk, responded to questions from Committee Members and

reviewed the proposed policy. Shane Baker, Chief Administrative Officer, reviewed the origins of the proposed policy and discussed potential options to address social media communications.

Main Motion

That the proposed Public Conduct Policy (ATT-1) be approved by Council.

Amendment

Moved by: S. Collier

That the motion be amended by adding the following provision:

That staff be directed to report back with options to address behaviour on social media.

CARRIED

Main Motion as Amended

Moved by: L. Bower

That the proposed Public Conduct Policy (ATT-1) be approved by Council; and

That staff be directed to report back with options to address behaviour on social media.

CARRIED

4.7 **Assumption of Subdivisions**
S-A-2003-10 Menkes Phase 4
S-A-2005-04 Mountcliffe
S-A-2005-08 Heroes Pointe

Moved by: M. Crawford

(1) That the works and services within the following Plans of Subdivision be assumed by the Town:

a) (S-A-2003-10) – Menkes Phase 4
Owner: Menkes Ajax Holdings Limited
Agreement Date: May 18, 2012
Registered Plan: 40M-2472
Refer to Appendix "A"

b) (S-A-2005-04) – Mountcliffe
Owner: Mountcliffe Development Inc.
Agreement Date: September 30, 2008
Registered Plan: 40M-2390
Refer to Appendix "B"

c) (S-A-2005-08) - Heroes Pointe
Owner: Luvian Homes (Salem Road) Limited
Agreement Date: July 4, 2012
Registered Plan: 40M-2491
Refer to Appendix "C"

(2) That the corresponding Assumption By-laws be prepared for an upcoming Council meeting.

CARRIED

4.8 **Amendment to North Station Street Property Agreement of Purchase and Sale: Ledim Development Ltd.**

Moved by: M. Crawford

1. That staff be directed to prepare an Amending Agreement of Purchase and Sale with Ledim Development Canada Ltd. for the sale of the North Station Street Property; and

2. That a by-law to approve the Amending Agreement of Purchase and Sale with Ledim Development Ltd. be presented to Council at its meeting of December 20, 2019.

CARRIED

4.9 **Downtown Community Improvement Plan Program Suspensions**

Committee Members discussed the timing and completion of staff's review of the Downtown Community Improvement Plan Program.

Main Motion

1. That Staff review the Downtown Community Improvement Plan to determine the continued appropriateness and feasibility of the programs, including a review of funding criteria, project areas and any other applicable parameters, and report back to General Government Committee prior to December 31, 2020; and

2. That the Rehabilitation Grant Program and Planning and Development Fees Grant Program in the Downtown Community Improvement Plan be suspended until December 31, 2020.

Amendment

Moved by: S. Collier

That the motion be amended to direct staff to report back by June 30, 2020.

CARRIED

Main Motion as Amended

Moved by: S. Collier

1. That Staff review the Downtown Community Improvement Plan to determine the continued appropriateness and feasibility of the programs, including a review of funding criteria, project areas and any other applicable parameters, and report back to General Government Committee prior to June 30, 2020; and

2. That the Rehabilitation Grant Program and Planning and Development Fees Grant Program in the Downtown Community Improvement Plan be suspended until December 31, 2020.

CARRIED

4.10 **Expression of Interest in United Shoreline Ontario Rally**

Rachael Matheson, Senior Communications Officer – Government Relations, and Christie McLardie, Manager of Public & Strategic Affairs, reviewed an upcoming opportunity to host an event with United Shoreline Ontario to raise awareness for emergency response to high water levels and regulation of Great Lakes water levels. R. Matheson noted that the event would occur in early 2020.

Committee Members asked questions regarding direction required for staff to pursue the matter, correspondence received from the Eastern Ontario Mayors' Caucus, reporting on water levels along the Ajax shoreline, and potential for a presentation from the Central Lake Ontario Conservation Authority (CLOCA) regarding high water levels. R. Matheson, C. McLardie, and Kevin Tryon, Manager of Engineering Development Approvals & Stormwater Management, responded to questions from Committee Members and discussed timing of the event, prior Council positions on climate change and the environment, direction sought to proceed with the event, and potential for a future presentation from CLOCA.

Moved by: S. Collier

1. Staff be directed to communicate the Town's interest to United Shoreline Ontario to host an event in Ajax in early 2020; and

2. If successful, staff be given authority to coordinate and implement the event.

CARRIED

5. Discussion

None

6. Presentations

None

Closed Session (2:35 p.m.)

7. Authority to Hold a Closed Session

Moved by: L. Bower

That the Committee convene to a Closed Session pursuant to Sections 239 (2)(e) and 2(f) of the Municipal Act, 2001, as amended, to discuss a matter pertaining to litigation or potential litigation, including matters before administrative tribunals, affecting the municipality or local board, and a matter of advice subject to solicitor-client privilege, including communications necessary for that purpose.

CARRIED

7.1 **AMHC Update**

7.2 **Durham Live Minor Variance Applications**

The meeting recessed at 2:35 p.m.

The meeting resumed at 2:44 p.m.

Open Meeting (3:49 p.m.)

Ratify Actions Taken In Closed Session

Moved by: J. Dies

That all directions approved in the Closed Session be ratified.

CARRIED

8. Adjournment (3:50 p.m.)

Moved by: L. Bower

That the December 20, 2019 meeting of the General Government Committee be adjourned.

CARRIED

Chair

D-Clerk